



PROJECT MUSE®

Clitics in Phonology, Morphology, and Syntax (review)

Joseph F. Eska

Language, Volume 79, Number 3, September 2003, pp. 653-654 (Review)

Published by Linguistic Society of America

DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1353/lan.2003.0156>



➔ *For additional information about this article*

<https://muse.jhu.edu/article/46739>

Pattern and process: A Whiteheadian perspective on linguistics. By MICHAEL FORTESCUE. (Human cognitive processing 6.) Amsterdam: John Benjamins, 2001. Pp. vii, 311. ISBN: 1588110583. \$95.00.

Alfred North Whitehead (1861–1947) is remembered largely for his writings on mathematics and philosophy, and it may come as a surprise to see a book devoted to linguistic metatheory written in the context of his world of ideas. In this thoughtful essay, published as part of a recently inaugurated series on human cognition and language (the first volume, Ning Yu's *The contemporary theory of metaphor: A perspective from Chinese*, Amsterdam: John Benjamins, appeared in 1998), Fortescue revisits the perennial dichotomy between linguistic form and function. More importantly, he reassesses the contemporary orientational division between formalists and functionalists from a temporally detached perspective. By revealing the linguistics in Whitehead's 'philosophy of organism', F is able to reassess the positions of both generativists and functionalists from a refreshingly neutral vantage, though F himself 'confesses' (3) to being more in sympathy with the functionalists. The result is a thought-provoking journey into philosophical and sometimes metaphysical realms that proves to be of unexpected relevance to the possible future trajectories of many trends dominant in linguistics today, from optimality theory to emergent grammar.

There are nine chapters and two appendices. After answering the anticipated question 'Why Whitehead?' (1–23), F proceeds to apply Whitehead's writings on symbolism to language behavior (cf. especially Alfred North Whitehead, *Symbolism, its meaning and effect*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1928). Although this is the first thoroughgoing attempt to connect Whitehead's 'philosophy of organism' with modern linguistics, its outlines were already adumbrated in F's earlier monograph, *A discourse production model for twenty questions* (Amsterdam: John Benjamins, 1980). F's core argument throughout is that form and function—though distinct in the Saussurean sense—are far more interdependent in reality than many linguists have been wont to treat them. Whitehead's philosophy provides one key to this new holism. Individual chapters explore language as a unified system of signs but also separately from a form-oriented and a content-oriented perspective. There are also discussions of mental language processing, the comprehension of written texts, and the role of the individual language user in the historical transmission of language. F argues that language must be conceived of as a 'complex external object' rather than an 'organism'. He further suggests (256) that full human language could well have

developed as a postevolutionary consequence of social transmission rather than strictly in tandem with biological changes. Finally, F admonishes the linguist that *langue* and *parole*—or pattern and process—though real, separable aspects of language often warranting their own approaches, can never be studied entirely apart from one another.

Appendix 1 (245–50) briefly assesses Whitehead's legacy within modern philosophy. Appendix 2 (251–53) uses Whiteheadian principles to schematically represent the production of the utterance 'I wouldn't have thought it was possible'. There is also a lengthy accumulation of endnotes (255–98) that more than reward the effort needed to check and read them as one moves through the chapters.

Any book that helps to bridge the often unnecessarily deep divide between formalism and functionalism is well worth the read. This is one such book. [EDWARD J. VAJDA, *Western Washington University*.]

Clitics in phonology, morphology, and syntax. Ed. by BIRGIT GERLACH and JANET GRIJZENHOUT. (Linguistik Aktuell/Linguistics today 36.) Amsterdam: John Benjamins, 2000. Pp. xi, 441. ISBN: 1-55619-799-3. \$114.00.

The status and nature of clitics have been and continue to be a vibrant area of linguistic research, with many fundamental questions still unresolved: Are they arguments or functional heads? Is their placement phonologically or syntactically driven, or both? Are they attached to lexical words or prosodic phrases? Do they move to their surface position or are they base-generated there? What lies behind the strict ordering that is usually found within clitic clusters? These and many other matters are addressed from a wide range of perspectives in the fourteen articles in this collection that grew out of a workshop held at the 1999 meeting of the German Society of Linguistics in Konstanz. Everyone interested in clitics would do well to acquaint themselves with this highly diverse volume that draws on a variety of crosslinguistic data.

BIRGIT GERLACH and JANET GRIJZENHOUT examine clitics from various perspectives, conclude that they are affixes attached to phonological phrases, and favor seeing them as base-generated in their surface position. AKINBIYI AKINLABI and MARK LIBERMAN investigate the tonal behavior of six types of enclitics in Yoruba and discuss five devices employed to avoid violations of a constraint against the final syllable of the host and the clitic possessing the same tone. ARTEMIS ALEXIADOU and MELITA STAVROU employ evidence provided by possessive clitics in Greek to propose that there are two possessor positions within

the DP. GLORIA COCCHI uses a clitic shell framework to claim that Romance pronominal clitics and Bantu bound personal affixes are both best analyzed as arguments of the verb rather than as agreement markers.

BERTHOLD CRYSMANN proposes that pronominal clitics in European Portuguese should be regarded as morphosyntactic hybrids within an HPSG framework. LINDA ESCOBAR and ANNA GAVARRÓ provide experimental evidence on differences in the acquisition of strong vs. clitic pronominals in Catalan to test whether binding is innate. ANTONY DUBACH GREEN demonstrates that, while proclitics are normally attached outside of the prosodic word of the host in Irish, various phonological processes can cause all or part of the clitic to be incorporated into the host's prosodic word.

In three papers on Romanian, GÉRALDINE LEGENDRE provides an OT account which argues that auxiliary and pronominal clitics are phrasal affixes subject to conflicting PF alignment constraints that delineate their positioning; PAOLA MONACHESI employs an HPSG framework to argue that pronominal and intensive clitics are morphological affixes but that auxiliary and negative clitics are words subject to syntactic processes; and ALBERT ORTMANN and ALEXANDRA POPESCU propose that the postposed definite article is an inflectional suffix and extend their analysis to Albanian and Bulgarian.

DONALD F. REINDL and STEVEN FRANKS use OT constraints to model a metrical module which is superimposed over the normal system to account for features of clitics in Serbian folk songs that are otherwise ungrammatical. ANDREW SPENCER uses the framework of paradigm function morphology to treat Bulgarian clitics as phrasal affixes and to account for their fixed order and extends his analysis to Macedonian. OLGA MIŠESKA TOMIĆ identifies two classes of clitics in Macedonian—pronominal and auxiliary clitics are inflectional; negative and interrogative *wh*-clitics are operators—and examines the variable positioning of clitic clusters. Finally, JUAN URIAGEREKA explores a possible correlation between clitic doubling in languages such as Spanish and the semantics of inalienable possession within the framework of the minimalist program. [JOSEPH F. ESKA, *Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University*.]

A dictionary of European anglicisms.

Ed. by MANFRED GÖRLACH. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2001. Pp. xxvi, 352. ISBN: 0198235194. \$105.00.

The editor and sixteen consultants, each from a different European country, document in this dictionary, the first of its kind, the numerous English loanwords that have found their way into German, Dutch,

Norwegian, Icelandic, French, Spanish, Italian, Romanian, Russian, Polish, Croatian, Bulgarian, Finnish, Hungarian, Albanian, and Greek. Happily, they are indicated for ease of reference in the same fixed order throughout (first Germanic, followed by Romance, Slavic, Uralic, and [Indo-European] Balkan). When the project began in 1993, the cutoff date of 1995 was arbitrarily selected.

First, a few words of praise for some of the book's outstanding features. The English etymon serves as a convenient headword for the forms listed. It should be noted that many proper names are not included since the process by which names become actual utilitarian 'words' is different in individual languages, thus making it impossible to decide what to include and what not to include. Thus, one will not find such lemmas as *Weightwatchers*. Two other classes of words also proved most difficult to handle: internationalisms (like *telephone*), and words unknown to educated readers. Fortunately, the latter have been 'intentionally omitted' (xix).

Let me now briefly comment on the methodological aspects of this work. If an anglicism entered a language via another language, this fact is duly noted. If there is any doubt about the facts of transmission, a question mark is inserted in parentheses. For example, the word *baby* is said to be 'one of the earliest and most widespread anglicisms' (xxi, 11), but it was transmitted via French, in which an earlier rendition can be noted as *bébé* and a later one preserves the English orthography intact. However, I believe that sometimes the exact transmission would be most difficult to resolve. For example, let us take up the case of *mango*. The editor stipulates that the word comes from Portuguese, but ultimately derives from Tamil 'with uncertain English mediation' (195). Furthermore, in the case of the word *igloo*, we read that 'its status as an anglicism is . . . uncertain' even though we read that it was transmitted via Canadian English and possibly French (160). How can the editor rule out American English and British English as being sources as well since Americans and Britons have written about igloos, Eskimos, and Alaska? On the other hand, *dingo* 'a wild Australian dog' is said to be questionable as an anglicism, but how else could it have penetrated Icelandic, Romanian, French, and Spanish, etc. (88)?

In a few cases, it is possible to spot American English as the donor language rather than British or other dialects. Consider the case of *gin-tonic* (133), which shows up in Spanish as [jintonik] but in Romanian and Hungarian as *gin and tonic* (corresponding exactly to American English). The spelling of *center* over British *centre* (53) is increasingly prevalent not only in Europe but also in China (e.g. *fitness center*), as I can attest from a recent trip to that country during August 2002.

Let me conclude with three details. First, it is fasci-